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ally feels comfortable in hand, but sadly, these aspects almost always take the second level of importance, with the primary focus being performance and camera, where it simply isn't a match for the other smartphones in the segment.



Intex Aqua Trend

Motorola's reliance on trying to offer more than just performance has led to a smartphone that falls behind most smartphones in terms of speed and ease of usage. While the water resistance might come handy in certain scenarios, it is something that many will agree to live without, in exchange of a stutter-free phone experience.

INTEX AQUA TREND

The Intex Aqua Trend is a decent-looking smartphone, when you unbox the device. Moving on from the point, there is nothing supremely commendable about it. Its build feels cheap, although its compact form factor feels easy to hold in hand. The 5-inch, 720p HD display is not bad,

featuring decent colours which are a tad on the oversaturated end. Nevertheless, viewing angles are good, and even the device buttons feel sturdy, so it does make a pleasant device within the price bracket, overlooking the cheap build and a failed attempt to emulate HTC's design language.

The interface is where it looks somewhat tacky. The icons are rather chunky, reminiscent of the very first smartphones that attempted in packing in premium features to a cheap clamshell. It is powered by a 1.3GHz MediaTek MT6735 quad-core processor, along with 2GB of RAM and 16GB of internal storage, bringing it at par with most of the devices in this segment. Gaming on it is reasonably smooth, although long usage will lead to stutters and slight heating of the device. Network retention was good, and calling and other essential tasks did not face any notable hitch. Battery life was decent, churning out a stamina result of 9 hours on our tests, and lasting more than a day in one full charge cycle.

The audio quality is really poor, and that, coupled with the amateur interface and poor build quality takes the Intex Aqua Trend out of contention. While it still remains a choice that is remotely worth being considered (looking at Intex's major distribution to offline stores in tier-2 and tier-3 cities in India), it is simply not in league with the rest of the smartphones in this shootout. A good, commendable attempt at bringing budget-scale performers to wider Indian audience.

XIAOMI MI 4I

The Xiaomi Mi 4i commands the highest price tag among all the smartphones in this seg-

ment, and hence, had some justification to make for a price of almost ₹3,000 higher than the average price here.

The Xiaomi Mi 4i runs on a Qualcomm Snapdragon 615 SoC, along with 2GB of RAM and 16GB of internal storage. It has been a proven performer - a proven powerhouse in this segment. There are no performance qualms in terms of regular usage, gaming or any type of heavy usage. The 5-inch, 1080p Full HD display is one of the best in this segment, with crisp, warm colours that are true to the original source. Audio quality is pristine in comparison to the other cellphones in this category, and its 13-megapixel camera is stellar.

Additionally, Xiaomi has further extended its support for the Mi 4i by launching its latest ROM, MiUI 7, based

on the device. The Mi 4i feels good to hold, the UI looks and feels premium, and the overall experience, for us, is worth paying the premium. In a world of smartphone featuring bigger screens by the day, the Mi 4i does stunningly well in retaining the compact form that a smartphone should ideally have, according to us.

You will not face any major battery issues, which will last you through the day. The Mi 4i is also the lightest device among the nine featured here, adding more to ergonomics. Like Meizu, the Xiaomi Mi 4i has a balanced, compact performance and usage trend, which fuses good, suave design with good performance and a decent, growing after-sales service by Xiaomi.

Defending the price tag? We feel so.

HONOR 4X

The Honor 4X runs on Huawei's HiSilicon Kirin 620 1.2GHz octa-core SoC, with 2GB of RAM and 8GB of internal storage. Although additional storage support is present, more insistence by applications to run on the inbuilt memory may mean that you might soon run out of storage space on your internal memory.

Performance by the Honor 4X is reasonably decent - gaming experience is smooth barring a few stutters after continued gaming or heavy usage crosses the 30-minute mark, and browsing is, as expected, flawless for the most part. The best thing to note about the Honor 4X is its robust battery stamina, returning 20 hours of battery life in our battery test. The 5.5-inch, 720p HD makes up for the lack of Full HD resolution by delivering decent colours, viewing angles and visibility, thereby not making us



Xiaomi Mi 4i